

Yushi Sugimoto, Ph.D.

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Research Interests

- Computational Neurolinguistics; Neuro-computational modeling of language processing naturalistic methods, fMRI, MEG, EEG
- Theoretical Linguistics; Generative Grammar; Creole Grammars; Creole Formation/Multilingualism

Employment

- April 2024 – Lecturer, **THE UNIVERSITY OF OSAKA (OSAKA, JAPAN)** Graduate School of Humanities, [Division of Language and Culture](#), Discipline III (Theoretical Linguistics and Digital Humanities)
- April 2022 – March 2024 Project Researcher ([Yohei Oseki's lab](#)), **THE UNIVERSITY OF TOKYO (TOKYO, JAPAN)** Graduate of Arts and Sciences, [Department of Language and Information Sciences](#)
Funded by [MEXT KAKENHI Grant-in-aid for Transformative Research Area \(B\)](#)

Research Positions

- April 2017 – June 2018 Research Fellow (DC2)
Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS)
- September 2016 – March 2017 Research Support Staff (RS), Waseda University

Grants

- April 2025 – March 2028 JSPS Grant-in-Aid for Young Scientists
- January – August 2022 [Rackham Humanities Research Fellowship](#)
- May – August 2021 [John D'Arms Faculty Award Graduate RA](#)
- April 2017 – June 2018 [Grant-in-Aid for JSPS Fellows \(17J03420\)](#)
- September 2017 – May 2018 [JSPS Overseas Challenge Program for Young Researchers \(201780049\)](#)

Education

- 2018 – 2022 **Ph.D. in Linguistics.** University of Michigan, Ann Arbor
Thesis title: *Underspecification and (im)possible derivations: Toward a restrictive theory of grammar*
- 2016 – 2020 **Doctoral Program [withdrawn]** Sophia University, Tokyo, Japan
Graduate School of Languages and Linguistics
- 2014 – 2016 **MA in Linguistics.** Sophia University, Tokyo, Japan
- 2010 – 2014 **B.A in English and American Literature.** Keio University, Tokyo, Japan

Non-Degree

- September 2017 – May 2018 Visiting Student, University of Michigan, Department of Linguistics

Education (continued)

Summer 2013

LSA Linguistic Institute. University of Michigan, Ann Arbor.

Publications

Journal Articles

- 1 Alan Ke, Andrew McInnerney, and Yushi Sugimoto, "Lack of c-command in coordinate structures: Evidence from binding," *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory*, 2025, [All authors equally contributed to this work].  DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11049-025-09662-8>.
- 2 Yushi Sugimoto, Ryo Yoshida, Hyeonjeong Jeong, Masatoshi Koizumi, Jonathan R. Brennan, and Yohei Oseki, "Localizing Syntactic Composition with Left-Corner Recurrent Neural Network Grammars," *Neurobiology of Language*, vol. 5, no. 1, pp. 201–224, Apr. 2024.  DOI: [10.1162/nol_a_00118](https://doi.org/10.1162/nol_a_00118).
- 3 Yushi Sugimoto and Acrisio Pires, "A parameter-free underspecification approach to complementizer agreement," *Revista Linguística*, vol. 18, no. 1, pp. 62–81, 2023.  DOI: <https://doi.org/10.31513/linguistica.2022.v18n1a56350>.
- 4 Yushi Sugimoto and Marlyse Baptista, "A late-insertion-based exoskeletal approach to the hybrid nature of functional features in creole languages," *Languages*, vol. 7, no. 2, 2022, ISSN: 2226-471X.  DOI: [10.3390/languages7020092](https://doi.org/10.3390/languages7020092).
- 5 Yushi Sugimoto, "Labeling defective T," *Studia Linguistica*, vol. 75, no. 1, pp. 150–164, 2021.  DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1111/stul.12154>.

Conference Proceedings

- 1 Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto, and Yushi Sugimoto, "When the grammar doesn't mind which merge it chooses," in *Proceedings of the West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics*, Robert Autry, Gabriela de la Cruz, Luis A. Irizarry Figueroa, Kristina Mihajlovic and Tianyi Ni and Ryan Smith, and Heidi Harley, Eds., 2024, pp. 61–70.  URL: <http://www.lingref.com/cpp/wccfl/39/abstract3617.html>.
- 2 Taiga Someya, Yushi Sugimoto, and Yohei Oseki, "JCoLA: Japanese corpus of linguistic acceptability," in *Proceedings of the 2024 Joint International Conference on Computational Linguistics, Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC-COLING 2024)*, Nicoletta Calzolari, Min-Yen Kan, Veronique Hoste, Alessandro Lenci, Sakriani Sakti, and Nianwen Xue, Eds., Torino, Italia: ELRA and ICCL, May 2024, pp. 9477–9488.  URL: <https://aclanthology.org/2024.lrec-main.828>.
- 3 Andrew McInnerney and Yushi Sugimoto, "On dissociating adjunct island and subject island effects," in *Proceedings of the Linguistic Society of America*, vol. 7, May 2022, p. 5207.  DOI: [10.3765/plsa.v7i1.5207](https://doi.org/10.3765/plsa.v7i1.5207).
- 4 Savithry Namboodiripad, Nicole Cuneo, Mathew A. Kramer, Yourdanis Sedarous, Felicia Bisnath, Yushi Sugimoto, and Adele Goldberg, "Backgroundedness predicts island status of non-finite adjuncts in english," in *Proceedings of the 44th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 2022, pp. 1087–1093.
- 5 Takanobu Nakamura and Yushi Sugimoto, "Apparent de re construals of de se anaphor in japanese," in *Proceedings of 28th Japanese/Korean Linguistics*, Oct. 2021.
- 6 Yushi Sugimoto, "Move-agree or agree-move? on the movement theory under free merge," in *Proceedings of 13th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics*, Aug. 2018.
- 7 Yushi Sugimoto, "Not so hyper: A-movement beyond clause boundaries?" In *Proceedings of 12th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics*, Sep. 2017, pp. 273–280.
- 8 Yushi Sugimoto, "De-phased by external pair-merge of c to t and its consequences," in *Proceedings of The Conference of the Student Organisation of Linguistics in Europe XXIV*, Dec. 2016, pp. 237–253.

- 9 Yushi Sugimoto, “Pair-merge as free merge,” in *Proceedings of the 17th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar. Case and Agreement in Minimalism*, Aug. 2015, pp. 491–510.

Books and Chapters

- 1 Alan Ke, Andrew McInerney, and Yushi Sugimoto, *Introducing Language and Mind* (Cambridge Introductions to Language and Linguistics). Cambridge University Press, under contract.
- 2 Noam Chomsky, T. Daniel Seely, Robert C. Berwick, Sandiway Fong, M. A. C. Huybregts, Hisatsugu Kitahara, Andrew McInerney, and Yushi Sugimoto, *Merge and the Strong Minimalist Thesis* (Elements in Generative Syntax). Cambridge University Press, 2023.  DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1017/9781009343244>.

Conference Presentations

- 2025  Shinnosuke Isono*, Kohei Kajikawa*, Yushi Sugimoto*, Masayuki Asahara, and Yohei Oseki. 2025. Exploring spatial and temporal dynamics of language comprehension in the brain with CCG. The 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society. Marriott Marquis, San Francisco, USA. [*co-first authors] [poster]
-  Shinnosuke Isono*, Kohei Kajikawa*, Yushi Sugimoto*, Masayuki Asahara, and Yohei Oseki. 2025. Modeling Japanese EEG data with CCG. Annual Meeting of [the Association for Natural Language Processing \(NLP2025\)](#), Nagasaki, Japan. [theme section] [*co-first authors]
-  Yushi Sugimoto, Ryo Yoshida, Hyeojeong Jeong, Akitake Kanno, Masatoshi Koizumi, and Yohei Oseki. 2025. BCCWJ-MEG: A novel Japanese MEG dataset. Annual Meeting of [the Association for Natural Language Processing \(NLP2025\)](#), Nagasaki, Japan. [poster]
- 2024  Yushi Sugimoto, Ryo Yoshida, Hyeojeong Jeong, Akitake Kanno, Masatoshi Koizumi, and Yohei Oseki. 2024. [Investigating Syntactic Attention in the brain](#). [Society for the Neurobiology of Language 16th Annual Meeting](#), Brisbane, Australia, October 24-26, 2024. [poster]
-  Yushi Sugimoto. 2024. Boxing and Remnant Movement. [SMOG & ANU International Conference on Syntax and Semantics \(ICSS2024\)](#), Andong National University, Southern Korea, August 20, 20-24. [online] [Invited]
-  Taiga Someya, Yushi Sugimoto, Yohei Oseki. 2024. JCoLA: Japanese Corpus of Linguistic Acceptability. [LREC-Coling 2024](#). Lingotto Conference Centre, Torino, Italia, May 25-30, 2024. [poster]
- 2023  Acrisio Pires and Yushi Sugimoto. 2023. A Parameter-free Underspecification Approach to Complementizer Agreement. The 53rd Linguistic Symposium on Romance Languages [[LSRL53](#)], June 29th, Paris, France.
-  Yushi Sugimoto and Marlyse Baptista. 2023. A Novel Feature of the complementizer system in Cabo Verdean Creole. The 53rd Linguistic Symposium on Romance Languages [[LSRL53](#)], June 29th, Paris, France.
-  Yushi Sugimoto, Ryo Yoshida, Hyeojeong Jeong, Masatoshi Koizumi, Jonathan R. Brennan, and Yohei Oseki. 2023. Modeling Japanese fMRI data with left-corner Neural Network Grammar. Annual Meeting of [the Association for Natural Language Processing \(NLP2023\)](#), Okinawa, Japan, March 16th, 2023. [poster] [[proceedings in Japanese](#)]
- 2022  Savithry Namboodiripad, , Felicia Bisnath, Nicole Cuneo, Matthew A. Kramer, Yourdanis Sedarous, Yushi Sugimoto, and Adele Goldberg. 2022. Backgroundedness predicts island status of non-finite adjuncts in English. [The 44th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society](#), Metro Toronto Convention Centre, Toronto, Canada, July 30th, 2022.

Conference Presentations (continued)

- Alan Ke, Andrew McInnerney, and Yushi Sugimoto. 2022. Lack of c-command in coordinate structures: Evidence from binding. *45th Generative Linguistics in the Old World [GLOW45]*, Queen Mary University of London, April 28th, 2022. [online oral presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution] [Acceptance rate 11% (24 out of 213)]
- Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto and Yushi Sugimoto. 2022. Privileges of the Rich. *The 46th Penn Linguistic Conference [PLC46]*, March 19th, 2022. [online poster presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]
- Andrew McInnerney, and Sugimoto, Yushi. 2022. On dissociating adjunct island and subject island effects: syntactic vs. extrasyntactic approaches. *The 96th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America [LSA2022]*, Washington D.C., January 6th, 2022 [online poster presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]
- Yushi Sugimoto and Marlyse Baptista. 2022. On the nature of the hybrid grammar of creole formation: a case study of functional features. *The 96th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America [LSA2022]*, Washington D.C., January 6th, 2022 [online poster presentation due to COVID-19]
- 2021
 Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto and Yushi Sugimoto. 2021. Adding a locus of variation as underspecification. *Workshop on Linguistic Variation at the Interfaces II*, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, November 18th, 2021. [online oral presentation due to COVID-19]
- Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto and Yushi Sugimoto. 2021. When the grammar doesn't mind which Merge it chooses. *The 39th meeting of the West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics, [WCCFL39]*, hosted by The University of Arizona's Department of Linguistics, April 11th, 2021. [published material] [online oral presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]
- Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto and Yushi Sugimoto. 2021. Options of Externally Merging {v, T, C} — a Comparative Approach. *The 45th Penn Linguistic Conference [PLC45]*, March 20th, 2021. [online oral presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]
- Andrew McInnerney, and Yushi Sugimoto. 2021. Subject Islands in a Simplest Merge System. *The 95th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America [LSA2021]*, January 9th, 2021 [online poster presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]
- Takanobu Nakamura, and Yushi Sugimoto. 2020. Where does the 'self' come from? A *de se* binding approach to *zibun* in Japanese. *28th Japanese/Korean Linguistics Conference [JK28]*, September 16th, 2020. [online poster presentation due to COVID-19, second author]
- 2020
 Yushi Sugimoto. 2020. A dynamic process in forming structural backbone of creole languages. *The 94th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America [LSA2020]*, New Orleans, January 3th, 2020. [poster]
- 2018
 Takanobu Nakamura, and Yushi Sugimoto. 2018. Long distance relativisation and phasal transfer of KP. *Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Association of Great Britain [LAGB]*. University of Sheffield, UK. September 14th, 2018 [poster, second author].
- Yushi Sugimoto. 2017. Move-Agree or Agree-Move? On the movement theory under free Merge. *The 13th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics [WAFL13]*. International Christian University, Japan, May 27th, 2017. [poster]
- 2016
 Yushi Sugimoto. 2016. Not so Hyper: A-movement Beyond Clause Boundaries? *Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics 12 [WAFL12]*. Central Connecticut State University, US, May 14th, 2016. [poster]
- Yushi Sugimoto. 2016. De-Phasing Effect: External Pair-Merge of phase head and non-phase head. *39th Generative Linguistics in the Old World [GLOW39]*, Linguistics in Göttingen, Germany, April 6th, 2016. [poster], Abstract published in [GLOW Newsletter #76](#), 176-178.

Conference Presentations (continued)

- Yushi Sugimoto. 2016. De-Phased by External Pair-Merge of C to T and Its Consequences. *The Conference of the Student Organisation of Linguistics in Europe* [ConSOLE XXIV], The University of York and York St. John University, UK, January 8th, 2016.
- 2015 ■ Yushi Sugimoto. 2015. Pair-Merge as Free Merge. *The 17th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar* [SICOGG17] at Kyung Hee University, Seoul, Korea, August 5th, 2015.

Workshops

- 2023 ■ Andreas Blümel and Sugimoto, Yushi. An Attempt at Thinking Inside the Box. Workshop “Towards an SMT-compliant I-language system: On an SMT-based Merge with segregation,” The 41th Annual Meeting of the English Linguistic Society of Japan, Organizer: Yushi Sugimoto (University of Tokyo), Participants: Nobu Goto (Toyo University), Toru Ishii (Meiji University), Andreas Blümel (University of Göttingen), University of Tokyo, Tokyo. November 4th, 2023. [program]
- Yushi Sugimoto. Movement and the Box Theory: An Overview of Current Issues in Minimalism. Workshop “Towards an SMT-compliant I-language system: On an SMT-based Merge with segregation,” The 41th Annual Meeting of the English Linguistic Society of Japan, Organizer: Yushi Sugimoto (University of Tokyo), Participants: Nobu Goto (Toyo University), Toru Ishii (Meiji University), Andreas Blümel (University of Göttingen), University of Tokyo, Tokyo. November 4th, 2023. [program]
- 2022 ■ Yushi Sugimoto. 2022. Sub-extraction and MERGE. Workshop “On Minimal Search,” The 40th Annual Meeting of the English Linguistic Society of Japan, Organizer: Nobu Goto (Toyo University), Participants: Toru Ishii (Meiji University), Andreas Blümel (University of Göttingen), November 5th, 2022. [online presentation]
- 2021 ■ Yushi Sugimoto. 2021. From Merge to MERGE. Workshop “Toward a Genuine Explanation in Linguistic Theory” *The 162th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of Japan*, Japan. Organizer: Takanori Nakashima (Tohoku University), Participants: Jun Omune (Kansai Gaidai University), Norimasa Hayashi (Kyushu University), and Yushi Sugimoto (University of Michigan), June 27th 2021. [online due to COVID-19]
- 2019 ■ Yushi Sugimoto. 2019. Possible modes of pair-Merge. Workshop “Exploring Pair-Merge of Heads,” *The 37th Annual Meeting of The English Linguistic Society of Japan*. Organizer: Nobu Goto (Toyo University), Participants: Nobu Goto (Toyo University), Yushi Sugimoto (University of Michigan), Andreas Blümel (University of Göttingen), Kwansei Gakuin University, Osaka, Japan, November 9th, 2019.
- 2016 ■ Yushi Sugimoto. 2016. Phase theory, raising and language variation between Japanese and English. Workshop “The current Issues of comparative syntax” *The 153th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of Japan*, December 14th 2016, at Fukuoka University, Japan. Organizer Ryoichiro Kobayashi (Sophia University), Participants: Takakazu Nagamori (Sophia University) and Yushi Sugimoto (Sophia University)

Talks

- 2024 ■ Merge of Functional Heads: A Theory of Amalgamation, JSPS Core-to-Core Program “International Research Network for the Human Language Faculty”, International Workshop 2024, Osaka University, Osaka, Japan, 12/07/2024
- Modeling Syntactic Composition in the brain with Small/Syntactic Language Models, talk at Hiromu Sakai’s lab meeting, Waseda University, Japan, 11/05/2024
- A Late-Insertion-Based Exoskeletal Approach to the Hybrid Nature of Functional Features in Creole Languages, Core-to-Core Program (member internal meeting/seminar), Osaka University, Osaka, Japan, 04/23/2024 [online]

Talks (continued)

- 2023
- Modeling Japanese fMRI data with left-corner Neural Network Grammar, Waseda University, Tokyo, Japan, 08/06/2023 [poster]
 - Modeling Japanese fMRI data with left-corner Neural Network Grammar, Setagaya Linguistic Circle, Tokyo, Japan, 06/03/2023
 - Recombination of Functional Features: A Late-Insertion-Based Exoskeletal Approach to Creoles (with Marlyse Baptista), [Penn Syntax Lab](#) meeting, Pennsylvania, US, 04/07/2023. [online]
 - A fresh view of SMT [Review of Chomsky's talks at KEIO-EMU lecture series] Keio study group on generative grammar, Tokyo, Japan, 03/22-23/2023 [online]
 - BCCWJ-MRI/MEG. [AI Yotta International Symposium](#). Tohoku University, Sendai, 03/10/2023 [online]
 - Merge of Functional Heads: A Theory of Amalgamation (with Andreas Blümel and Nobu Goto), [Tohoku University](#), Sendai, Japan, 02/12/2023 [Invited]
- 2022
- A Late-Insertion-Based Exoskeletal Approach to the Hybrid Nature of Functional Features in Creole Languages, 10/01/2022 [Keio Linguistic Colloquium](#), Tokyo, Japan [online] [Invited]
- 2021
- Disentangling CED effect under MERGE “Toward a Genuine Explanation in Linguistic Theory” (organizer: Takanori Nakashima, participants: Takanori Nakashima, Jun Omune, Norimasa Hayashi, and Yushi Sugimoto), [Keio Linguistic Colloquium](#), Tokyo, Japan, 08/01/2021, [online], [handout](#)
 - From Merge to MERGE. “Toward a Genuine Explanation in Linguistic Theory” (organizer: Takanori Nakashima, participants: Takanori Nakashima, Jun Omune, Norimasa Hayashi, and Yushi Sugimoto), [Keio Linguistic Colloquium](#), Tokyo, Japan, 07/31/2021, [online], [handout](#)
 - Deducing parametric variation from options of Merging functional heads. (with Andreas Blümel and Nobu Goto) [Artemis Alexiadou's](#) lab meeting, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Germany, 05/17/2021 [online]
 - From Merge to MERGE. “Toward a Genuine Explanation in Linguistic Theory” (organizer: Takanori Nakashima, participants: Jun Omune, and Norimasa Hayashi), Keio Study Group on Generative Grammar, Keio University, Tokyo, Japan, 05/15/2021 [online]
 - Parameters Revisited: Free Modes of Introducing Functional Heads. (with Andreas Blümel and Nobu Goto) Keio Study Group on Generative Grammar, Keio University, Tokyo, Japan, 01/30/2021 [online]
- 2017
- Merge, minimal search and {XP, YP} structures. “Labeling, Search, and Principled Universal Properties of Languages” (organizer: Takashi Munakata, participants: Nobu Goto and Masanobu Sorida), [Keio Linguistic Colloquium](#), Keio University, Tokyo, Japan, 07/08/2017
 - Merge of Heads: weak phases and {XP, YP} structures. Kansai syntax research groups, Ryukoku University, Osaka, Japan, 03/04/2017
 - The current issues of generative enterprise. Waseda University, Center for English Language Education in Science and Engineering (CELESE) special meeting, 02/20/2017

Miscellaneous Work

- August 2022
- Underspecification and (im)possible derivations: Toward a restrictive theory of grammar. [Ph.D Thesis](#), University of Michigan, Ann Arbor
Committee: Acrisio Pires (co-chair), [Marlyse Baptista](#) (co-chair), [Richard L. Lewis](#), [Terje Lohndal](#)
- August 2020
- Subject Condition Effect in Japanese Redux. Qualifying Research Paper, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor.
First Reader: Acrisio Pires; Second Reader: Natasha Abner

Teaching Experience

April 2025 (expected)–	 Introduction to Psycholinguistics The University of Osaka, Osaka, Japan
	 Integrated English (Content-based English) The University of Osaka, Osaka, Japan
April 2024–	 Integrated English (Liberal Arts & Sciences) Osaka University, Osaka, Japan
September 2023 – February 2024	 Intermediate/Advanced Syntax (ADVANCED STUDIES IN LINGUISTICS 16) Keio University, Tokyo, Japan Topics: Cognitive science, Language evolution, Merge, Agree, Syntactic Islands, Phase Theory, Comparative Syntax
	 English communication II Tokyo University of Agriculture, Tokyo, Japan
April – August 2023	 Intermediate/Advanced Syntax (ADVANCED STUDIES IN LINGUISTICS 15) Keio University, Tokyo, Japan Topics: X'-theory, Binding theory, Island constraints, <i>v</i> P shell, DP, TP, CP
	 English communication I Tokyo University of Agriculture, Tokyo, Japan
April – August 2017	 Industrial English Tokyo Polytechnic University, Kanagawa, Japan
September 2016 – February 2017	 Industrial English Tokyo Polytechnic University, Kanagawa, Japan

Graduate Student Instructor (GSI, University of Michigan)

Fall 2021	 COGSCI200: Introduction to Cognitive Science (Instructor: Professor Richard Lewis) Topics: Perception, Bayesian Inference, Phrase Structure Grammar, Turing Machine, Q-Learning, Prospect Theory, Emotion, Consciousness
Winter 2021	 LING111: Introduction to Language (Instructor, Associate Professor Ezra Keshet)
Fall 2020	 LING209/PSYCH242/COGSCI209: Language and Human Mind (Instructor, Associate Professor Jonathan Brennan) Rationalism/Empiricism, Language and Thought, Basis of Linguistics, Language Acquisition, Psycholinguistics, Universal Grammar
Winter 2020	 LING111: Introduction to Language (Instructor, Associate Professor Ezra Keshet)
Fall 2019	 LING111: Introduction to Language (Instructor, Professor Andries Coetzee)

Teaching Assistant (Sophia University)

April – August 2017	 Language and Cognition 1 (Instructor, Associate Professor Hiroki Narita)
April – August 2016	 Language and Cognition 1 (Instructor, Associate Professor Hiroki Narita)

Teaching Experience (continued)

April – August 2015

📖 **Language and Humans 1**
(Organizer Prof. Ryosuke Takahashi)

Skills

- 📖 Python (Nilearn, MNE-Python, Eelbrain)
- 📖 R
- 📖 $\text{\LaTeX}$

References

Available on Request